

READ THIS FIRST - printing, transferring, punching, setting

1 PRINT AT 100%

Print every page at 100% / Actual Size. Turn OFF "fit to page", "shrink to fit" and "scale to paper size" - they are on by default in most print dialogs and they are the single most common way a template comes out the wrong size.

Then go to page 2 and measure the scale bars before you cut anything.

2 ONE SHEET, NO TAPE

The whole 268 x 132 mm template is on page 3, turned 90 degrees to fit a single US Legal sheet. Turn the paper sideways to read it.

Check the length across the piece against the flat-piece dimension printed along its head edge (268 mm) before you trust it.

3 TRANSFER TO LEATHER

You need a piece at least 280 x 144 mm (11.0 x 5.7 in) to have something to hold on to.

Cut the paper template out and lay it OUTSIDE FACE UP on the grain side of the leather. The outline is a symmetric rounded rectangle, so it traces the same either way up - but the flap must end up on the BACK cover, so keep track of which panel is which.

Mark the corners and the four fold lines lightly with a scratch awl, and prick all 7 hole centres through the paper.

4 PUNCH THE HOLES - BEFORE YOU CREASE

2.5 mm round punch for the 6 elastic holes, 3 mm for the single closure hole. A folded panel will not sit flat under a punch, so all punching happens while the piece is still flat. Punch into end grain or a poly board.

The dotted ring around each hole is the eyelet FLANGE footprint, drawn at 5.5 mm. Set one eyelet in a scrap first and measure its flange: if yours is wider than 5.5 mm, neighbouring flanges will touch and you should open the spacing in the build script before cutting the real piece.

5 SET THE EYELETS

6 eyelets at 2.5 mm for the elastics, 1 at 3 mm for the closure. Set from the OUTSIDE so the finished flange shows on the outside of the spine and the rolled side sits inside where the inserts run.

Work from the middle of each cluster outward, and check the piece stays flat - a spine with 6 eyelets in it will bow if you over-set them.

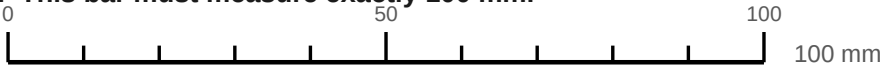
6 CREASE, THEN ASSEMBLE

Dampen the grain slightly and run a bone folder along a straight edge on each of the three solid fold lines. Fold away from the grain side.

Closure elastic first, then the three insert elastics. Each one goes out through its hole and is stopped with a knot against the eyelet on the outside.

SCALE CHECK - measure these before you cut anything

A. This bar must measure exactly 100 mm.

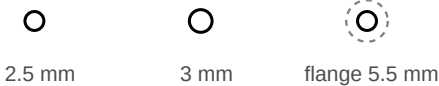


B. This bar must measure exactly 6 inches.



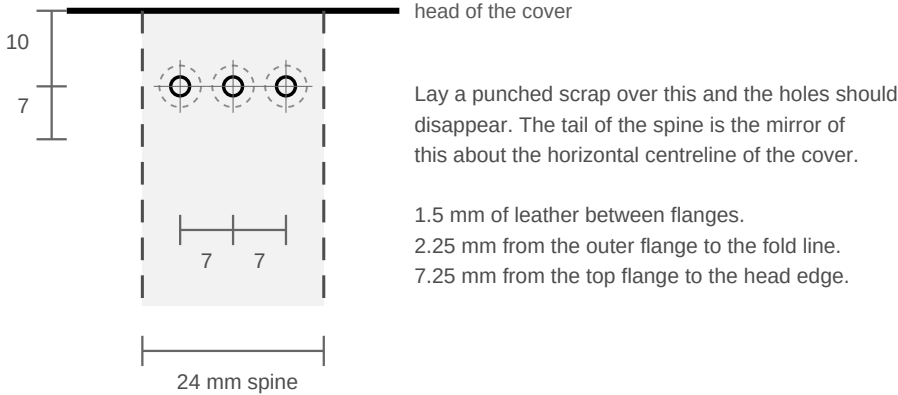
If either bar is short, your print dialog scaled the page. Reprint at 100% / Actual Size with "fit to page" off. Do not try to compensate by cutting slightly bigger.

C. Holes and eyelet flanges, shown at true size.



Drop one of your own eyelets on top of the dotted ring. If its flange is wider than 5.5 mm the spacing in this template is too tight - see the tuning notes in the guide.

D. Top of the spine at true size - punch layout.



FULL-SIZE TEMPLATE - one sheet, no tiling - turn the page 90 degrees

